

SEKIRO

Shadows Die Twice — The Complete Guide

Overview

Sekiro: Shadows Die Twice is an action-adventure game developed by **FromSoftware** and published by Activision, released on March 22, 2019. Set in a reimagined late Sengoku-era Japan, it follows a shinobi named **Wolf (Ookami)** on a mission to rescue his kidnapped lord and take revenge on his enemies. Unlike FromSoftware's Souls series, Sekiro emphasizes precise sword combat, stealth, and vertical traversal using a grappling hook prosthetic arm. It won the prestigious **Game of the Year 2019** at The Game Awards.

Quick Facts

Detail	Info
Developer	FromSoftware
Publisher	Activision
Release Date	March 22, 2019
Platforms	PS4, Xbox One, PC, Stadia
Genre	Action-Adventure / Stealth
Setting	Late Sengoku-era Japan (1500s)
Protagonist	Wolf (Ookami) — The One-Armed Wolf
GOTY	The Game Awards 2019

Story & Setting

The game takes place in a fictionalised version of **Sengoku-period Japan**, filled with samurai clans, corrupt nobles, and supernatural creatures rooted in Japanese folklore. Wolf is a shinobi devoted to protecting the young lord **Kuro**, who carries the **Dragon's Heritage** — a divine bloodline granting immortality. When a rival clan kidnaps Kuro and severs Wolf's arm, Wolf is revived by the Sculptor's Idol, fitted with a **Prosthetic Tool Arm**, and sets out on a path of vengeance and sacrifice. The story explores themes of loyalty, sacrifice, undying devotion, and the cost of immortality.

Gameplay Mechanics

- **Posture System:** Combat revolves around breaking the enemy's Posture (balance) by deflecting attacks perfectly, rather than depleting HP alone.
- **Deflection & Parry:** Precise timed blocks deflect enemy attacks and fill their Posture meter — the core skill of Sekiro's combat.
- **Shinobi Prosthetic:** Wolf's mechanical arm holds interchangeable tools — Shuriken, Flame Vent, Loaded Spear, Umbrella Shield, and more.
- **Resurrection:** Wolf can resurrect once (or twice with upgrades) after death, enabling dramatic mid-fight comebacks.
- **Grappling Hook:** A built-in grapple allows vertical exploration, rooftop traversal, and aerial death blows.

- **Stealth & Deathblows:** Enemies can be silently eliminated with a single Deathblow from stealth, rewarding patience.
- **Skill Trees:** Players unlock combat arts, latent skills, and shinobi techniques by accumulating experience.

Key Characters

Character	Role	Notable Trait
Wolf (Ookami)	Protagonist, shinobi	Resurrectable, one-armed warrior
Kuro	Young lord, Wolf's master	Bearer of Dragon's Heritage
Genichiro Ashina	Primary antagonist	Brilliant samurai, seeks immortality
Lady Butterfly	Illusionist, trainer	Wolf's former mentor, deadly assassin
Guardian Ape	Fearsome boss	Iconic decapitation-resurrection fight
Isshin Ashina	Legendary swordsman	Final boss (one form), grandfather of Genichiro
The Sculptor	Prosthetic craftsman	

Most Iconic Bosses

- **Genichiro Ashina** — The skill-check boss. Teaches players the core deflection system early.
- **Lady Butterfly** — A mesmerising illusion-weaving assassin who punishes aggression.
- **Guardian Ape** — Famous for its shocking second phase after seemingly being defeated.
- **Corrupted Monk** — A three-phase phantom boss requiring complete mastery of deflection.
- **Demon of Hatred** — An enormous optional boss, the hardest test of prosthetic tools.
- **Isshin, the Sword Saint** — Widely considered one of the greatest final bosses in gaming history.

Multiple Endings

Ending	How to Achieve	Outcome
Shura	Obey the Iron Code	Wolf becomes a demon — bad ending
Immortal Severance	Purify the Lotus	Kuro dies, Dragon's Heritage severed
Purification	Collect all items + sacrifice	Wolf dies to free Kuro — true love
Return (True)	Dragon's Tears + items	Wolf fully healed, Kuro set free — best ending

Awards & Legacy

Sekiro won **Game of the Year 2019** at The Game Awards, beating titles like Death Stranding and Control. It also won Best Action Game and received over 300 GOTY nominations across publications. Critically, it holds a **Metacritic score of 90** on PC and was praised for its uncompromising difficulty and masterful combat design. Sold over **10 million copies** globally, it remains one of FromSoftware's best-selling titles and cemented the studio's reputation for challenging, deeply rewarding game design.

Did You Know?

- The name 'Sekiro' means 'One-Armed Wolf' in Japanese (Seki = one-armed, ro = wolf).
- Director Hidetaka Miyazaki said Sekiro was inspired by old Japanese samurai films and manga.
- The game has no character creation — Wolf is a fixed protagonist, a first for FromSoftware's modern era.
- Sekiro has no multiplayer — no co-op, no invasions. It is a purely solo experience.
- The Guardian Ape's second phase (headless) became one of the most shocked-about gaming moments of 2019.
- A speedrunner completed Sekiro in under 20 minutes using precise knowledge of boss patterns.

"I am Wolf. I do not fear death." — Sekiro: Shadows Die Twice

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